GF.1.1 Epistemic staircase

Claim status is tiered; foundational certainty cannot leak into downstream hypotheses.

Tier 0 — Bedrock / First-Person Datum

0

Experience is occurring: there is presence now. Neither postulated nor derived.

Exactly one item; no other claim may enter Tier 0. Doubting or dreaming is itself experience.

Axiom 1 generalises by stipulation (Tier 1); objective idealism remains a Tier 3 choice.

No Level II substrate verdict follows: open (Tier 3) / NOT_EVALUATED.

Tier 1

1

Structural axioms or logical necessities that anchor the framework.

Example: canonical Wheeler-DeWitt form H Psi equals zero (adoption is Tier 3); lattice action postulate hbar hat equals one.

Tier 1/2

1/2

Architectural postulate + conditional mathematics: adopted choices plus exact consequences; the premise is not promoted.

Example: icosahedral projection (E8 to H4, then a rank-six H3 module on the adopted primitive lattice Z6); adopted, not forced.

Tier 2

2

Geometric consequences derived inside the 6D -> 3D icosahedral cut-and-project ansatz.

Example: Lepton harmonic-ladder mechanism (phi^11, phi^17); the specific integers N = 11, 17 remain Tier 3 anchors.

Tier 3

3

Phenomenological or calibrated rows whose first-principles closure remains open.

Example: Biological lag tau lag; PMNS mixing angles (bare theta_23 = 45 degrees inside the NuFIT 3 sigma range; octant unresolved).

Tier 4

4

Exploratory calculations or ontological extensions outside the core falsifiable theory.

Example: Identity persistence across bodies; phi-formula matches read as evidence that phi is special (App PSC §PSC.9.6).

No upward promotion without closure

- axiom-level closure
- proof obligation
- calibration to derivation
- OOM bound

Source: Front Matter, The Epistemic Tier System